HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People in authority can't be trusted"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People in authority can't be trusted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who hurt me?
- ☐ Who has been fair?
- ☐ What signs show a safe leader?
- ☐ When do I obey God over people?
- ☐ What does measured trust look like?
- ☐ Who can support me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My ultimate trust is in the Lord.
- ☐ God directs hearts where He pleases.
- ☐ Not every authority is unsafe.
- ☐ I can obey God over people when they conflict.
- ☐ Trust can be measured.
- ☐ I can protect myself wisely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 118:8–9**
  "It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man. It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in princes."
- ☐ **Proverbs 21:1**
  "The king's heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases."
- ☐ **Acts 5:29**
  "But Peter and the other apostles replied, 'We must obey God rather than men.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

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Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Measured trust: Each week, note one interaction where you gave measured trust and what happened.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 118:8–9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I take refuge in the Lord first, and I can trust people carefully.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Tell your story. Write what happened with the authority who hurt you.
- ☐ List trustworthy qualities. Write signs of safe leadership, such as honesty, consistency, and humility.
- ☐ Test small. Extend small trust to someone who shows these qualities.
- ☐ Get support. Talk to a counselor if your experiences involved abuse.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People in authority can't be trusted": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Measured trust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People in authority can't be trusted.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, some who held authority over me hurt me. Heal that wound. Teach me to trust You above all and to discern who is safe. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.